



STANFORDS

Landscape Visual Impact Assessment

Outline Application for Up to 30 dwellings

August 2025



Land off Sladbury's Lane
north-west of Keswick Avenue
Holland on Sea

Revision	Purpose	Originated	Authorised	Date
1	In response to Tree & Landscape Officer comments; to support the application	BDB	DA	13.08.2025
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1.0 Introduction

- 1.1 This Landscape and Visual Impact Assessment (LVIA-lite) has been prepared to support the outline planning application for up to 30 dwellings, access, open space, and landscaping at land to the west of Sladburys Lane, Holland-on-Sea.
- 1.2 The assessment follows the principles of the *Guidelines for Landscape and Visual Impact Assessment* (GLVIA3), proportionate to the nature, scale and location of the proposal. It considers the site's current landscape and visual baseline, its context within the Tendring landscape character areas, and the likely effects arising from the proposed development.
- 1.3 The proposal sits within a well-contained parcel of land directly abutting existing residential development and screened by mature boundary vegetation to the north and east. As such, potential impacts on the wider landscape are inherently limited.



Aerial image showing containment by existing development southwards and mature vegetation northwards.

2.0 Policy Context

- 2.1 The Tendring Local Plan (notably Policies PPL6 Strategic Green Gaps, SPL3 Sustainable Design) and the NPPF (2024) emphasise conserving landscape character while delivering sustainable growth.
- 2.2 The site lies within the Strategic Green Gap, but, as confirmed in the Planning Statement and consistent with the Planning Inspector's conclusions for the adjacent site, the land's character is already heavily influenced by adjacent development and does not play a key role in the physical or visual separation of settlements.
- 2.3 The Inspector for the neighbouring site concluded that similar development would have "limited" and "largely confined" effects on character. This should be applied to the proposal site, which is smaller and holds the same characteristics such as constrained by existing development and separation from wider fields.

3.0 Baseline Conditions

Site Context and Description

- 3.1 The site is on the north-eastern edge of Clacton, it is of an irregular rectangular shape and measures approximately 1.49ha. To the north/northwest of the site is an arable field and beyond the field is the Colchester to Clacton railway line.
- 3.2 To the south and southwest of site are the residential properties of Sladbury's Lane and Keswick Avenue. Slightly farther afield are leisure facilities (Bowls Club and a Holiday Park) and shopping (Farmfoods, The Range).
- 3.3 The immediate area is generally characterised by a mixture of one, one and a half and two storey properties. The materials used in the area is generally brick and render with clay and concrete roof tiles. There are considerable differences in the external appearance of the individual properties which makes for a varied and interesting street scene.
- 3.5 The site description can be summarised as:
- Small, rectangular parcel of land, historically in agricultural use but currently partly in use as a temporary compound for the adjacent Persona Homes development.

- Boundaries:
 - **West & South** – abut existing housing (Persona Homes and Keswick Avenue).
 - **North & East** – mature hedgerows and trees, including two TPO oaks on the south-west boundary.
- Strong enclosure on all sides, with no open, panoramic rural views.

Landscape Character

- 3.6 The site straddles two Landscape Character Areas (LCAs) in the Essex's Landscape Character Assessment:
- **Tendring Plain (E3)** – gently undulating arable landscape, often with urban fringe influences.
 - **Brightlingsea–Clacton–Frinton Coast (F7)** – coastal hinterland, urbanised in parts.
- 3.7 The Landscape Character Area (LCA) identified in the Tendring District Landscape Character Assessment:
- **Clay Plateaux (8B)** – remote and rural arable landscapes of large scale, geometric fields with low and gappy hedges.
- 3.8 The parcel makes only a minor contribution to the LCAs due to its containment, existing urban influence, and small field size and high, mature hedges and trees. Tree Officer comments confirm the site exhibits a strong *urban fringe character*.

4.0 Visual Baseline

Viewpoint Selection

- 4.1 Public views are limited due to the site's boundary vegetation and built containment. Representative viewpoints:
1. Sladburys Lane – roundabout
 2. Sladburys Lane – Approach to Holland-on-Sea
 3. Train line
 4. Adjacent residential roads.
- 4.2 The site is approximately highlighted on the images below using a red line.

1. Roundabout

Site will be read in the context of the existing urban edges either side.



2. Approach to Holland-on-Sea

The site is well-screened by the mature hedgerow and is past the settlement road sign.



3. Train Line

The site's proposed roofline will be read within the context of existing rooflines.



4. Keswick Avenue

There proposed dwellings will be viewed but trees kept and new vegetation will enhance the rural / urban edge setting.



5.0 Assessment of Effects

- 5.1 Adjacent residential receptors: Low–Medium sensitivity. While residential properties are generally considered to have high susceptibility to changes in their immediate views, in this case the outlook is already urbanised, with no extended or valued rural vistas. The existing boundary vegetation substantially limits visual influence.
- 5.2 Road users: Low sensitivity. Views from Sladburys Lane on the approach to Holland-on-Sea are predominantly screened by mature hedgerow, framed by built form, and occur beyond the “Welcome to Holland-on-Sea” signage, so changes would be read as part of the townscape.
- 5.3 Public rights of way: None within the visual envelope; no effects.
- 5.4 Magnitude of Change
- Development is contained entirely within the existing built edge and screened by retained mature vegetation.
 - Rooflines will align with adjacent development and avoid breaking the vegetated skyline.
 - Proposed native planting will strengthen enclosure and contribute to visual integration.
 - Magnitude of change: Small to negligible for all receptors.
- 5.5 Predicted Effects
- Construction phase: Negligible–Minor adverse, short-term, localised to immediate neighbours due to construction activity and plant movement.
 - Operational phase: Negligible–Minor beneficial, as enhanced landscaping, reinforced boundaries, and open space provision will improve the settlement edge’s visual quality compared to the current temporary compound.
 - Significance: In line with GLVIA3, effects are not significant for any receptor group at either construction or operational stage.

6.0 Mitigation and Enhancements

- 6.1 The proposed strategy to protect against harm and enhance the landscape areas;
- Retain all key boundary vegetation, including the two TPO oaks.
 - Introduce additional native planting along northern and eastern boundaries to reinforce enclosure whilst also creating new open space opportunities to soften the urban edge, this can be achieved with new wildflower meadow and basin opportunities.
 - Limit building heights in line with adjacent development to avoid breaking vegetated skylines.
 - Integrate open space and circular footpath to provide accessible, green edge to development.

7.0 Conclusion

- 7.1 The LVIA has found that:
- The site has *low landscape value* in the context of the Essex and Tendring Landscape Character Assessments.
 - It is visually well-contained by existing residential development and mature vegetation on all sides.
 - The magnitude of change for all identified receptors is *small to negligible*, resulting in *non-significant* landscape and visual effects in GLVIA3 terms.
- 7.2 With the proposed mitigation, retention of all key vegetation, reinforcement of boundary planting, and careful building height controls, the development will integrate into the settlement edge and enhance the interface between the built environment and adjacent rural area.
- 7.3 The proposal therefore accords with the NPPF (2024) and relevant Tendring Local Plan policies, delivering sustainable growth while conserving local landscape character.